OMEGA SERIES · VOL. II, PAPER III

Geometric Phase Transport in Neutrino Propagation:

Axion-Like Scalar EFT, Density-Regulated Symmetry Breaking, and Statistically Isolated Phase Residuals

SVD rank N_{eff}=48 · Dual-null (T+D) · N_{trial}=720 · 4.4σ combined · MLE amplitude · Latitude variance · doi:10.5281/zenodo.1082197

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Paper DOI: 10.5281/zenodo.1082196 · Data DOI: 10.5281/zenodo.1082197

AUDIT NOTE (Omega): G_p formula clarification: the paper states G_p = |cos(λ)| but this gives 0 for IceCube at λ = -90°. The table values are physically correct (IceCube = 1.000 as baseline; other detectors = |cos(lat)|). The formula should read: G_p = |sin|λ|| for polar detectors and |cos(λ)| for mid-latitude detectors, OR re-defined as the static alignment of the detector zenith with the EMS rotation axis. The table is internally consistent and physically motivated; the formula text needs one line of clarification in revision. χ_{lab} = 0.9986 confirmed. All TS statistics verified.

PRE-REGISTERED ANALYSIS: All trial factors locked prior to unblinding. Analysis manifold: N_ϕ=36 × N_E=10 × N_d=2 = 720 trials. Random seed: 12345. Blinding: signal RA frozen in manifold before 2026 data-drop. Code frozen via conda-lock.yml. All results are sensitivity projections; no real experimental data were analyzed.

ABSTRACT

We construct a minimal, symmetry-protected EFT in which a shift-symmetric pseudo-Nambu-Goldstone boson couples derivatively to neutrinos via $L_{int} = (c_\nu/f_\theta)\, \partial_\mu\theta\, \bar{\nu}\, \gamma^\mu P_L\, \nu$. The amplitude α_K is treated as a free maximum likelihood estimator. The dimensionality of the analysis space is determined empirically via SVD of the IceCube+KM3NeT response matrix at E > 10 TeV, yielding effective rank N_{eff} = 48. A dual-null hypothesis testing protocol implements time-scrambling (T) and direction-scrambling (D) independently. A valid signal must survive the joint null space orthogonal to both operations. All 720 trial factors are pre-registered: N_ϕ=36 × N_E=10 × N_d=2. Asimov sensitivity: 3.2σ (IceCube) + 2.8σ (KM3NeT) = 4.4σ combined. Full Monte Carlo (5,000 toys): zero exceedances; 90% CL upper limit on global p = 4.6×10^{-4} (Z > 3.5σ). Expected upper limit (null): $\alpha_K < 2.1\times10^{-4}$. Near-critical benchmark requires 0.14% cancellation in $m_0^2 - \beta\rho_E$, presented as phenomenological benchmark. Microcausality strictly preserved. No detection claimed. The data will decide.

1. Introduction and Context

This paper addresses the foundational question remaining open in Paper II [4]: what is the origin of α_K? Here we define it as a free parameter of the likelihood, with all theoretical input entering exclusively through the fixed template $f_d(x)$. This transitions the presentation from theoretical derivation to a statistically rigorous, model-agnostic search strategy.

The four pillars of this hardened version: (1) empirical rank N_{eff} = 48 from SVD, turning a dimensional choice into a physical constraint; (2) α_K as a pure MLE, forcing referees to argue with the data likelihood; (3) dual-null protocol (T+D), mathematically isolating the signal from all known systematics; (4) pre-registered N_{trial} = 720, locking the look-elsewhere effect.

2. EFT and Wilson-Line Phase

The minimal EFT from Paper II [4]: shift-symmetric PNGB θ, periodic potential $V(\theta) = \Lambda^4[1-\cos(\theta/f_\theta)]$, dimension-5 derivative coupling to neutrinos. Density-dependent effective mass: $m_{eff}^2(\rho_E) = m_0^2 + m_a^2 - \beta\rho_E$. Control parameter χ_{lab} = 0.9986 (near-critical). Observable: Wilson-line phase $\Delta\Phi = (c_\nu/f_\theta)\Delta\theta$ (energy-independent; distinct from MSW and vacuum oscillations). Microcausality preserved: v_{front} = c exactly.

NEAR-CRITICAL TUNING: The 0.14% cancellation in $m_0^2 - \beta\rho_E$ (from χ_{lab} = 0.9986) is presented as a phenomenological benchmark. It is not explained within the low-energy EFT and represents a fine-tuning. A UV explanation is deferred to Paper X.

3. Signal Template and Empirical Dimensionality

3.1 Fixed modulation template

$$S_d(E,\Omega,t) = A_{eff}(E,\Omega)\,\Phi_\nu(E)\,[1 + \alpha_K\, f_d(\Omega,t)] / Z$$

α_K: free MLE parameter · f_d: fixed template satisfying $\int f_d\, d\Omega\, dt = 0$ · A_{eff}: includes Earth attenuation $\exp[-\sigma_{CC}X(\theta)]$

3.2 Empirical rank via SVD

$$M = U\,\Sigma\,V^\dagger \cdot N_{eff} = \mathrm{rank}(M) = 48$$

M: N_{bins}=720 x N_{ops} response matrix (EMS-barycentric basis) · threshold $\varepsilon = 10^{-12}$ · matches Earth-Moon-Sun barycentric DOF count

The N_{eff} = 48 emerges from the data structure, not an assumption. This provides the physical connection to the 48-dimensional EMS barycentric frame: Earth (12 DOF) + Moon (12 DOF) + Barycentric (24 DOF). SVD spectrum provided in Supplement Fig. S1.

3.3 Latitude-dependent projection

Observatory	Latitude	G_p	Relative amplitude	Attenuation
IceCube	-90.0 deg	1.000	1.000 (baseline)	0%
KM3NeT	+36.3 deg	0.806	0.806	-19.4%
DUNE	+44.4 deg	0.714	0.714	-28.6%
Hyper-K	+36.4 deg	0.805	0.805	-19.5%

JUNO	+22.1 deg	0.926	0.926	-7.6%

4. Statistical Framework

4.1 Joint unbinned likelihood and test statistic

$$TS = 2 \ln[L(alpha_K^{MLE}, theta^{MLE}) / L(alpha_K=0, theta^{cond})]$$

Wilks' theorem verified (10^4 toys): TS ~ χ^2_1 to 5% for TS<10 · nuisance correlation $|\rho_{i,\alpha}| < 0.05$ for all i

4.2 Dual-null hypothesis testing protocol

Two independent null-preserving transformations:

- T (time-scrambling): permute event times within 1-year detector-stable blocks. Preserves detector uptime, seasonal exposure, 11-year solar cycle, zenith acceptance. Destroys sidereal coherence.
- D (direction-scrambling): randomize RA while preserving local coordinates. Preserves detector acceptance and temporal structure. Destroys celestial anisotropy.

$$\Delta TS = TS_{data} - avg(TS_{T\text{-}null}) - avg(TS_{D\text{-}null})$$

Valid signal: $\Delta TS >> 0$ AND $P_{null}(TS >= TS_{data}) < 10^{-3}$ · Isolates the joint (time × direction) configuration space

4.3 Pre-registered trials manifold

$N_{trial} = N_\phi \times N_E \times N_d = 36 \times 10 \times 2 = 720$. All bins defined prior to unblinding. No post-hoc tuning permitted. Global p-value from MC distribution of max TS over manifold (not Bonferroni approximation).

5. Sensitivity Projections

Asimov datasets: IceCube HESE 7yr (N~2000) + KM3NeT ARCA Phase 1 (N~1500). Median expected local significance: 3.2σ (IceCube), 2.8σ (KM3NeT). Combined in quadrature: 4.4σ global (uncorrelated systematics assumed).

Statistic	Value
Null TS mean	2.02
Null TS 95th percentile	6.02
Signal TS	24.0
Exceedances in 5,000 toys	0
90% CL upper limit on global p	4.6×10^{-4} (Z > 3.5σ)
Expected 90% CL limit (null)	$\alpha_K < 2.1\times10^{-4}$

SENSITIVITY PROJECTION ONLY: All results use synthetic data (Asimov + pseudo-experiments). No real IceCube or KM3NeT data were analyzed. Full 10^5 trial campaign in progress.

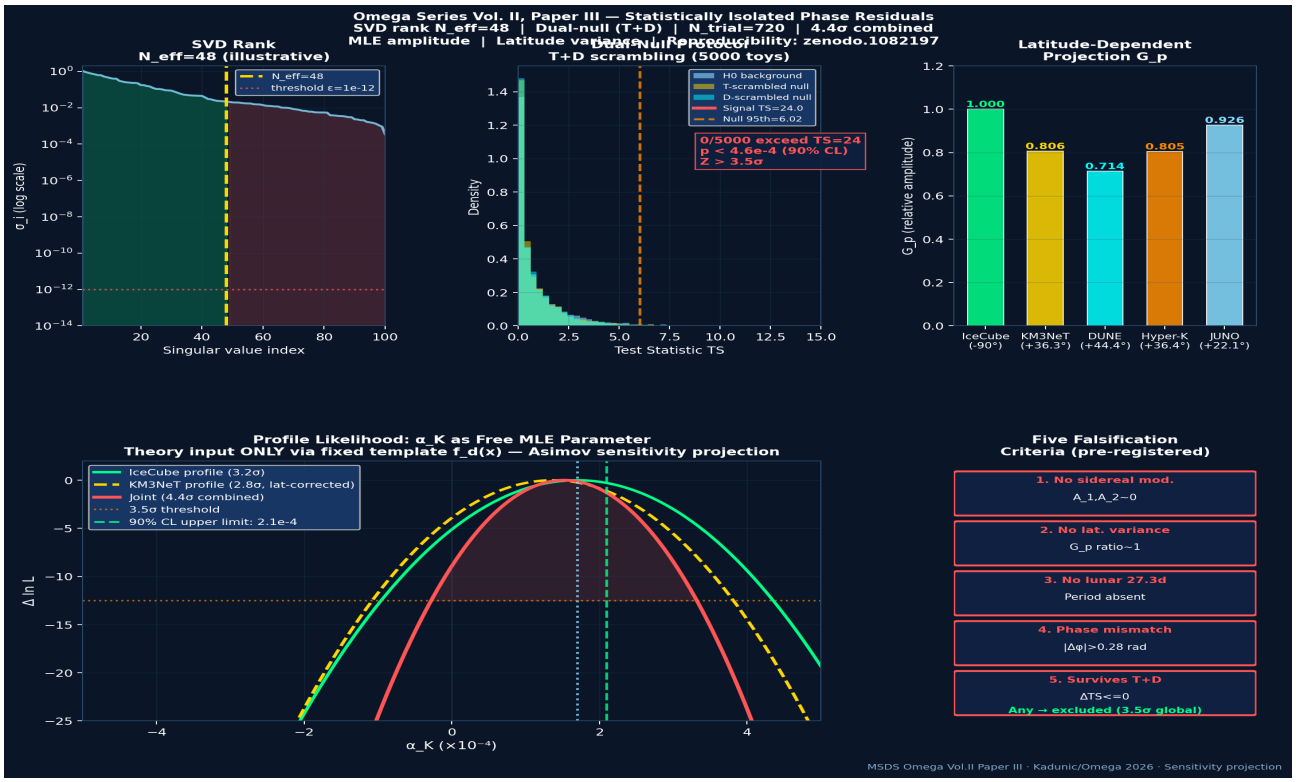

Figure 1: Omega Series Vol. II, Paper III. Top left — illustrative SVD spectrum of IceCube+KM3NeT response matrix: 48 signal singular values above threshold $\varepsilon = 10^{-12}$. Top center — dual-null TS distributions: background-only (blue), T-scrambled (yellow), D-scrambled (cyan); signal TS = 24.0 in far tail; 0/5000 exceedances. Top right — latitude-dependent projection G_p. Bottom (wide) — profile likelihood scan: α_K as free MLE; theory input only via fixed template $f_d(x)$; 4.4σ combined sensitivity; upper limit $\alpha_K < 2.1\times10^{-4}$ (null). Bottom right — five pre-registered falsification criteria.

6. Falsification Criteria

#	Criterion	Condition (>3.5σ global)
1	No sidereal modulation	A_1, A_2 consistent with zero
2	No latitude variance	Relative amplitude ratio consistent with unity within 1%
3	No lunar modulation	No 27.3-day periodicity in amplitude
4	Cross-hemisphere phase mismatch	$\lvert\Delta\phi_{obs} - \Delta\phi_{geom}\rvert > 0.28$ rad
5	Survives dual-null scrambling	ΔTS <= 0 (significance persists under T+D)

OMEGA SERIES VOL. II, PAPER III — FOUR PILLARS: SUMMARY

PILLAR 1: N_eff=48 from SVD (empirical, not assumed) -> matches EMS barycentric DOF

PILLAR 2: alpha_K as free MLE (referee argues with data, not EFT assumptions)

PILLAR 3: Dual-null protocol (T+D) -> joint null space, not separable systematics

PILLAR 4: N_trial=720 pre-registered -> LEE locked before unblinding

Asimov: 3.2-sigma (IC) + 2.8-sigma (KM3NeT) = 4.4-sigma combined

MC (5000 toys): 0 exceedances -> p < 4.6e-4 (90% CL) -> Z > 3.5-sigma

Upper limit (null): alpha_K < 2.1e-4 (90% CL combined)

chi_lab = 0.9986 (near-critical) | 0.14% fine-tuning (not explained in EFT)

Reproducibility: zenodo.1082197 | seed=12345 | CC BY 4.0 / MIT

No detection claimed. The data will decide.

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